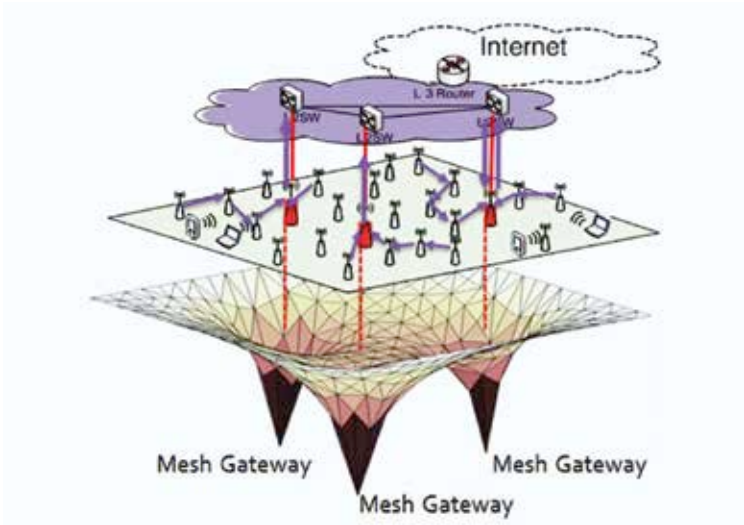




A possible configuration of wireless devices on a mesh network.

the devices on the cellular network. The cellular infrastructure is already in place and being regulated towards lower data costs. This means that devices can use it to transmit data globally thanks to the layered overlapping geographic network grid made by cell towers and base stations. However, over short distances the routing time and effort would make the technology ineffective for Internet of Things implementation.

Another alternative to the traditionally existing types of networks is that of mesh networks. These networks are custom designed and built by companies that wish to execute seamless Internet of Things connectivity in a stable environment. These small scale wireless networks work as relay transmitters which pass along data through a mesh or chain of nodes. This form of a network is decentralised and doesn't require a central hub to operate. And even though the range of the devices is small, it can hop across clusters of devices spread across a larger area. A potential mesh network can have hundreds or thousands of devices e.g. if every Android device is utilising this network system then there would be hundreds of million of contact nodes across a country like India through which signals could be transmitted. Currently there are a few mesh networks underway across the world but are not compatible with each other due to a lack of standardised protocols.